

Stakeholder Engagement Plan

SLM : Agriculture and Climate

Project	Domain-Specific SLM for Agriculture and Climate
Team	Kulal
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This document outlines the stakeholder engagement plan for the SLM : Agriculture and Climate project. It identifies the two primary stakeholder groups, explains what each group needs from the project, and describes how Team Kulal plans to involve, communicate with, and remain accountable to them. The plan is designed to ensure the model actually serves the people it was built for, not just the people who built it.

1. Stakeholder Overview

Two primary stakeholder groups have been identified based on who is most directly affected by the model and who holds the most influence over whether it succeeds in practice.

Stakeholder Group	Role in the Project	Level of Influence	Level of Impact
Smallholder Farmers	Primary end users of the model. Their questions drive the advisory outputs. Their farming outcomes determine whether the model is useful.	High — if the model does not work for them, the project fails regardless of technical performance.	High — incorrect or irrelevant advice can directly affect crop yield, income, and food security.
Agricultural Extension Officers and NGOs	Intermediaries who connect the model to farming communities. They validate advice quality, flag harmful outputs, and support model adoption at the community level.	High — they act as gatekeepers between the model and farmers, and are essential for reaching low-literacy or low-connectivity communities.	Medium — they are affected professionally but not directly dependent on the model for their own livelihoods.

2. Stakeholder Group 1 — Smallholder Farmers

Who they are

Smallholder farmers in Nigeria, primarily in the Sudan Savanna, Guinea Savanna, Derived Savanna, and Rainforest Belt agroecological zones. Women make up 60 to 80% of the smallholder agricultural workforce but are consistently underrepresented in formal agricultural data and digital tools. Many have limited formal education, limited smartphone experience, and limited or no reliable internet connectivity.

What they need from this project

- Advice that is practical and immediately usable, not academic or overly technical.
- Guidance that is specific to their crop, their zone, and their current season, not generic national-level advice.
- Language and reading level that matches how they actually communicate. Grade 8 English or below is the target.
- A tool they can access without reliable internet and without needing to type long queries.
- Confidence that the advice is trustworthy. Farmers who receive wrong advice once will not use the tool again.

Engagement approach

Method	Purpose	Timing	Who Leads
Community interview sessions	Gather indigenous farming knowledge and natural-language query patterns directly from farmers to shape training data.	Data collection phase, before model training.	Bilingual field researchers with extension experience.
Plain-language feedback sessions	Show farmers sample model outputs and ask whether the advice makes sense and feels useful. No technical framing.	After each model version is ready, before wider release.	Extension officers acting as facilitators.
Community summary sharing	Share a one-page plain-language summary of what the model was trained on and how to raise a concern. Given back to every participating community.	After each data collection phase.	Team Kulal, via NGO partners.
Feedback mechanism	Allow farmers (via extension officers) to flag advice that felt wrong, harmful, or irrelevant. Reports reviewed within 30 days.	Ongoing after deployment.	NGO partners collect and forward to Team Kulal.
Withdrawal option	Any farmer who contributed interview data can request removal of their contribution before dataset compilation.	During data collection phase.	Field researchers.

What we are asking of them

- Willingness to participate in community interview sessions (voluntary, oral consent accepted).
- Feedback on whether model outputs feel useful and trustworthy in practice.
- Openness to flag advice that feels wrong so the model can be improved.

What we owe them

- Accurate and agronomist-verified advice that will not harm their crops or livelihoods.
- Full anonymisation of their contributions. No names, locations, or identifying details stored.
- A plain-language report of how their knowledge was used.

- A working feedback channel that is actually monitored and acted on.
- The right to withdraw their data at any point before the dataset is compiled.

3. Stakeholder Group 2 — Agricultural Extension Officers and NGOs

Who they are

Government agricultural extension officers operating under state Agricultural Development Programmes (ADPs) and FMARD, as well as NGOs active in Nigerian rural agriculture such as Sahel Consulting, IITA outreach programmes, and community-based farmer organisations. These are the people who currently carry the responsibility of getting agricultural advice to rural communities, often covering areas far too large for the number of officers available.

What they need from this project

- A tool that genuinely extends their reach rather than replacing them or undermining their professional authority.
- Confidence in the quality of the advice the model gives. They will be blamed if a farmer follows bad advice that came through a tool they endorsed.
- A clear and simple way to flag incorrect or outdated advice so it can be corrected quickly.
- Enough context to explain the model to farmers and community leaders who may be skeptical of AI.
- Assurance that the model will not be used to cut extension service budgets or reduce their role.

Engagement approach

Method	Purpose	Timing	Who Leads
Initial briefing sessions	Introduce the project, explain what the model does and does not do, and address concerns about job displacement directly and honestly.	Before data collection begins in any community.	Team Kulal.
Co-facilitation of farmer interviews	Extension officers help identify and reach appropriate farming communities, and act as trusted intermediaries during interview sessions.	Data collection phase.	Extension officers, supported by field researchers.
Agronomist review partnership	Certified agronomists (ideally from ADP programmes) review all Q&A; pairs before inclusion in training data, lending institutional credibility to the corpus.	Throughout data collection and annotation.	Partner agronomists.
Output review sessions	Extension officers review model outputs on a representative sample of queries and flag anything inaccurate, dangerous, or culturally inappropriate.	Before each model release.	Team Kulal and extension officers jointly.

Structured feedback form	A simple form for officers to report problematic model outputs encountered in the field. Reviewed by Team Kulal within 30 days.	Ongoing after deployment.	Extension officers submit; Team Kulal reviews.
Annual partner update	A written summary of model updates, dataset changes, and issues that were flagged and resolved, shared with all partner extension programmes.	Annually.	Team Kulal.

What we are asking of them

- Participation in briefing sessions and willingness to raise concerns directly with the team rather than through third parties.
- Support in connecting the team to farming communities for data collection.
- Agronomist review of training data samples, with written sign-off before inclusion.
- Ongoing use of the feedback form when problematic outputs are encountered.

What we owe them

- Honest and transparent communication about what the model can and cannot do.
- Clear documentation that the model is a first-line advisory tool, not a replacement for professional extension services.
- Credit for their contributions to the data review and validation process.
- Prompt action on feedback. Any flagged output reviewed within 30 days, with a written response to the person who flagged it.
- Annual updates on model performance, dataset changes, and issues resolved.

4. Engagement Timeline

Phase	Activity	Stakeholders Involved
Before data collection	Briefing sessions with extension officers and NGO partners. Community leader consultations. Consent framework established.	Extension officers, NGO partners, community leaders.
Data collection	Farmer interview sessions co-facilitated with extension officers. Oral and written consent collected. Community summary promised.	Smallholder farmers, extension officers, field researchers.
Annotation and training	Agronomist review of all Q&A; pairs. Annotator calibration sessions. Bias monitoring across zones and gender.	Partner agronomists, annotation team.
Before model release	Output review sessions with extension officers. Farmer feedback sessions on sample outputs. Final agronomist sign-off.	Extension officers, smallholder farmers (sample), agronomists.

After deployment	Community summary shared with all participating communities. Feedback form active. Biannual dataset updates. Annual partner update report.	All stakeholder groups.
Five-year review	Full community re-consultation. Assessment of whether the model is still serving the communities it was built for. Decision on continued development.	All stakeholder groups, Team Kulal.

5. Accountability Commitments

Engagement is only meaningful if it leads to action. The following commitments define how Team Kulal will remain accountable to both stakeholder groups after the project is built.

Feedback response time	All flagged outputs reviewed and responded to within 30 days of receipt.
Dataset updates	Biannual updates aligned with the Nigerian farming calendar to keep seasonal guidance accurate.
Community reporting	Plain-language summary of model training and any significant changes shared with participating communities after each data collection phase.
Partner reporting	Annual written update to extension officer and NGO partners covering model performance, flagged issues, and resolutions.
Withdrawal rights	Any farmer who contributed data can request removal before dataset compilation. No questions asked.
No silent changes	Any significant change to the model scope, training data, or intended use will be communicated to stakeholder partners before it takes effect.
Five-year review	A formal re-consultation with all stakeholder groups five years after deployment to assess continued relevance and community benefit.
No commercialisation	The dataset and model will not be commercialised or shared with third parties without explicit agreement from originating institutions and communities.